Maran Kasa Feast of Merit & Tarang Monument

Resource Identifier: CULT-CUST-005

English Translation: The Feast of Merit Cycle and Sacred Post Erection

Category: Custom | Subcategory: Prestige_Institution

Village / Region: Ukhrul / Hunphun | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Hereditary Nobility & Benefactors (Documented in Hodson 1911, Horam 1977)

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Winter dry season (Sacred prestige institution)

Ethnographic Summary & Context:

The pinnacle institutional feast cycle hosted by a generous benefactor for the entire village, granting the lifelong cultural privilege of erecting the sacred forked Tarang post and adorning one’s home as a Lengcheng Shim.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Maran Kasa ot kasak iram mibingli phanit kachung mimi."

"Tarang lungphung kashak thada, Awunga wui mashun themthot pamei."

"Lengcheng Shimli kuihon kachui, thot kachungli aming kasak pamra."

English Translation & Meaning:

"The Maran Kasa feast of merit is the ultimate demonstration of generosity and civic honor."

"Erecting the monumental forked Tarang post, celebrating the nobility and virtue of the host."

"Privileged to raise the crossed roof-horns of the Lengcheng Shim, an enduring legacy for generations."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Accumulation of extensive agricultural surplus, livestock, and brewed rice wine over years.
2. Formal notification and blessing from the Awunga and village council of elders.
3. Hosting sequential feasts feeding the entire village and neighboring allied settlements.
4. Dragging and erecting the massive carved forked wooden post (Tarang / Tarung).
5. Attainment of highest social rank, granting permission to build a Lengcheng Shim house.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Benefactor Couple, Awunga, Village Clans, Neighboring Village Guests

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